

literary festival

Word Play

JAIPUR An American master of subversive satire once admitted, "Some writers take to drink, others take to audiences." The city is all set to glow pink as Gore Vidal and over 60 cultural doyens flock together for a no-holds-barred engagement with audiences at the Jaipur Literature Festival to celebrate the written word with a flourish between January 23 and 27.

If you're still wondering what makes this festival a classic, there's Ian McEwan, one of the greatest living craftsmen of contemporary fiction, whose moving story of a child's misconception, *Atonement*—now also a movie—lords over best-seller lists even six years after release, dodging competition from ever-new fiction. Manil Suri, best-selling author of *The Death of Vishnu*, will discuss his latest novel, *The Age of Shiva*, a tender tale of maternal instinct and feminine poignancy and Indra Sinha will elaborate on his Booker-nominated

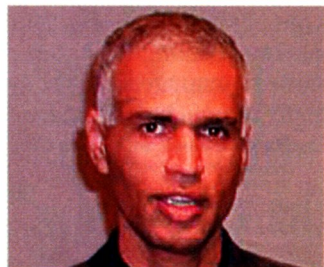
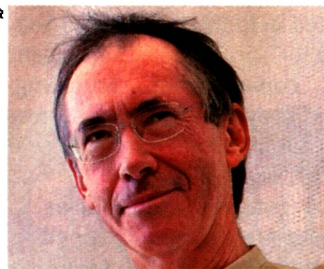
Animal's People. Don your literary raiment as cult sensation Donna Tartt speaks with poet Jeet Thayil and read between the lines with erudite expositions on globalisation and the adaptation of fiction for the big screen.

"It's the largest free literary festival in the world, completely egalitarian, nothing *sarkari* about it. Anyone can talk to the writers. It's a feast for the mind," says festival director William Dalrymple. And for the senses too. While Aamir Khan, whose shining celluloid feat *Taare Zameen Par* will be screened on January 25, will up the ante on parental sensitivity, Anoushka Shankar and Karsh Kale will present their new album.

This is not all. In the run-up to the five-day rendezvous, the literary forum Siyahi will make sense of India's legion of languages with the conference 'Translating Bharat' from January 20 to 22. Bookworms, amateur writers, cultural diletantes, come one, come all. At Diggi Palace.

by V. Shoba

PEN POWER: (Clockwise from L) McEwan, Vidal, Tartt, Suri



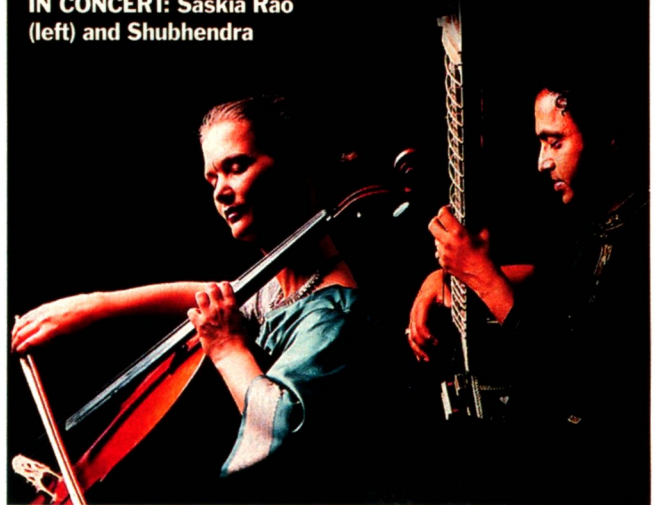
music

Melodies of the Day

MUMBAI Music concerts are usually held in the quiet of the dusk with evening or night ragas. But the Teen Prabar concert organised by the Banyan Tree features musicians from different parts of the country who play ragas according to the time of the day—the morning raga, Ahir-Bhairav, or the afternoon melody Todi, or the evening melody raga Puriya Kalyan. The concert features both solos and jugalbandis. Shailesh Bhagwat (shehnai) and Milind Raikar (violin), Shubhendra Rao (sitar), Saskia Rao (cello), Ustad Aslam Khan (vocal), Pandit Vishwamohan Bhatt (Mohan veena) and Shashank (flute) perform from 9 a.m. till 2 p.m. The 4 p.m. to 10 p.m. slot features the Gundecha Brothers (dhrupad), Kala Ramnath (violin) and Rupak Kulkarni (flute) as well as Devaki Pandit (vocal) and Shujaat Khan (sitar). The finale is a confluence of different rhythms led by Pandit Anindo Chatterjee and Anibrata Chatterjee. On January 26 at the Nehru Centre.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

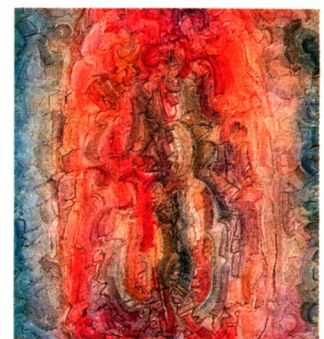
IN CONCERT: Saskia Rao (left) and Shubhendra



art

Abstract Brush

DELHI Sublime Encounters is a retrospective show by veteran artist Ambadas spanning four decades (1965-2005) in oil on canvas, ink and water colour, pen and ink and mixed media on paper. Ambadas is one of the pioneering artists who initiated the possibilities of the non-representational genre or 'abstract art' of painting



Ambadas's vivid colours in India. "I always intended to do away with every intention in my work," he says. At Delhi Art Gallery till February 10.